Steve White

Senior Frontend Engineer • Tech Lead

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Summary

Senior frontend engineer and tech lead with **15+ years of experience** building customer-facing ecommerce experiences and large-scale internal platforms. Expert in **React + TypeScript**, with growing full-stack depth across Next.js and federated GraphQL. Specializes in schema-driven, no-code tools (workflow automation, template CMSs, configurable UIs) that let technical and non-technical teams move without waiting on engineering. Background in design; AI-first workflow.

Skills

Core:	React, TypeScript, Next.js, GraphQL (Federation), Apollo, Redux, RTK Query, REST, SASS, Tailwind, Vanilla Extract
Full Stack:	Node.js, PHP, Java (working knowledge)
AI Tooling:	Cursor, Devin, cloud and local coding agents, custom agent skills
Testing & Quality:	Jest, React Testing Library, Cypress, Playwright, SonarQube
Tooling & CI/CD:	Git, Docker, Buildkite, Webpack, Storybook, GCP
Design:	UX collaboration, prototyping, low-fi mockups, component libraries
Leadership:	Technical leadership, cycle planning and sizing, cross-team and cross-platform alignment, former engineering manager

Experience

Wayfair

Boston, MA • 2014–Present

Senior Frontend Engineer — Storefront • 2025–Present

- Worked across three Storefront teams in one year, spanning upper-funnel pages (including the homepage) and site-wide Favorites; on-call for both.
- Led a ground-up refactor of our Favorites experience which included completely redesigning the backend for frontend layer and all the client codebases including web, android, and iOS. **This led to cutting down future feature requests from months to 1 week** of engineering effort.
- Built CMS-driven pages on Next.js and federated GraphQL, designing GraphQL schemas for CMS blocks that map directly to frontend components.
- Played a pivotal role in the re-architecture of our tracking events. This work required working with many teams, touching code that affected the entire web application, tracking down hidden business logic, collabing with data scientists and early mornings with engineers in India.
- **Cycle planning:** In 6-month planning, t-shirt size upcoming work, flag risks and cross-team dependencies early, and partner with Product to cover both technical and customer edge cases.

- **AI-assisted development:** Use AI coding agents daily (Cursor, Devin; cloud and local) and author custom agent skills, balancing speed with rigorous review and real understanding of new areas.

Senior Frontend Engineer — Communications Platform • 2018–2025

- Helped build a 7-person frontend team for Wayfair's in-house, SaaS-style communications platform, serving marketing, adtech, recommendations, order-related, and other teams across the company.
- Managed frontend engineers for a few years while being hands on with the code before moving to the IC tech-lead track.
- **Campaign & flow builder:** Co-architected and owned a visual, no-code, schema-driven workflow automation tool (similar to n8n) for triggers, conditional API calls, and node-based orchestration.
- Grew to **hundreds of users**, from marketing analysts to engineers across logistics and operations, running campaigns and post-order workflows without developer involvement.
- **Email template CMS:** Co-created a CMS that lets non-engineers build batch and triggered emails without dev support; a long-running production tool.
- Architected and maintained 7+ React/TypeScript/Redux SPAs with complex client-side state, delivering multiple redesigns while running parallel versions for operational continuity.

Frontend Engineer — Marketing Engineering • 2016–2018

- Owned development of marketing and transactional emails across all Wayfair brands, reaching millions of customers weekly.
- Built reusable, modular email template systems (PHP/XSLT → Handlebars/Node) that reduced build time and improved brand consistency.
- Began building internal tools for marketing teams, the start of a shift toward platform work.

HTML/CSS Engineer — Storefront • 2014–2016

- Developed new features for customer-facing pages for Wayfair and its sister sites using PHP, HTML, CSS, and JavaScript.
- Developed HTML/CSS email templates for marketing campaigns across brands.

ICON Advertising & Design

Designer / Web Developer • Boston, MA • 2011–2014

- Built static and dynamic websites for small and medium-sized businesses, delivering full-stack solutions (HTML, CSS, JavaScript, PHP) plus email campaigns.
- Designed visual assets (brochures, logos, event signage) and owned projects end-to-end in a scrappy, agency-style environment.

Side Projects

Travel Site — Next.js + Supabase photo gallery with Mapbox integration.

Van Pi Dashboard — Raspberry Pi + React wall interface for inverter control, sensors, and battery monitoring.

JSON Schema to UI — NPM package to generate UIs from JSON schemas.